NETHERBLOOM

Book of Remembrance

Open Crossing

The old grave-texts told the dead: do not drink from Lethe; find the spring of Memory. This Book is that spring.

THE SOUL OF THIS BOOK

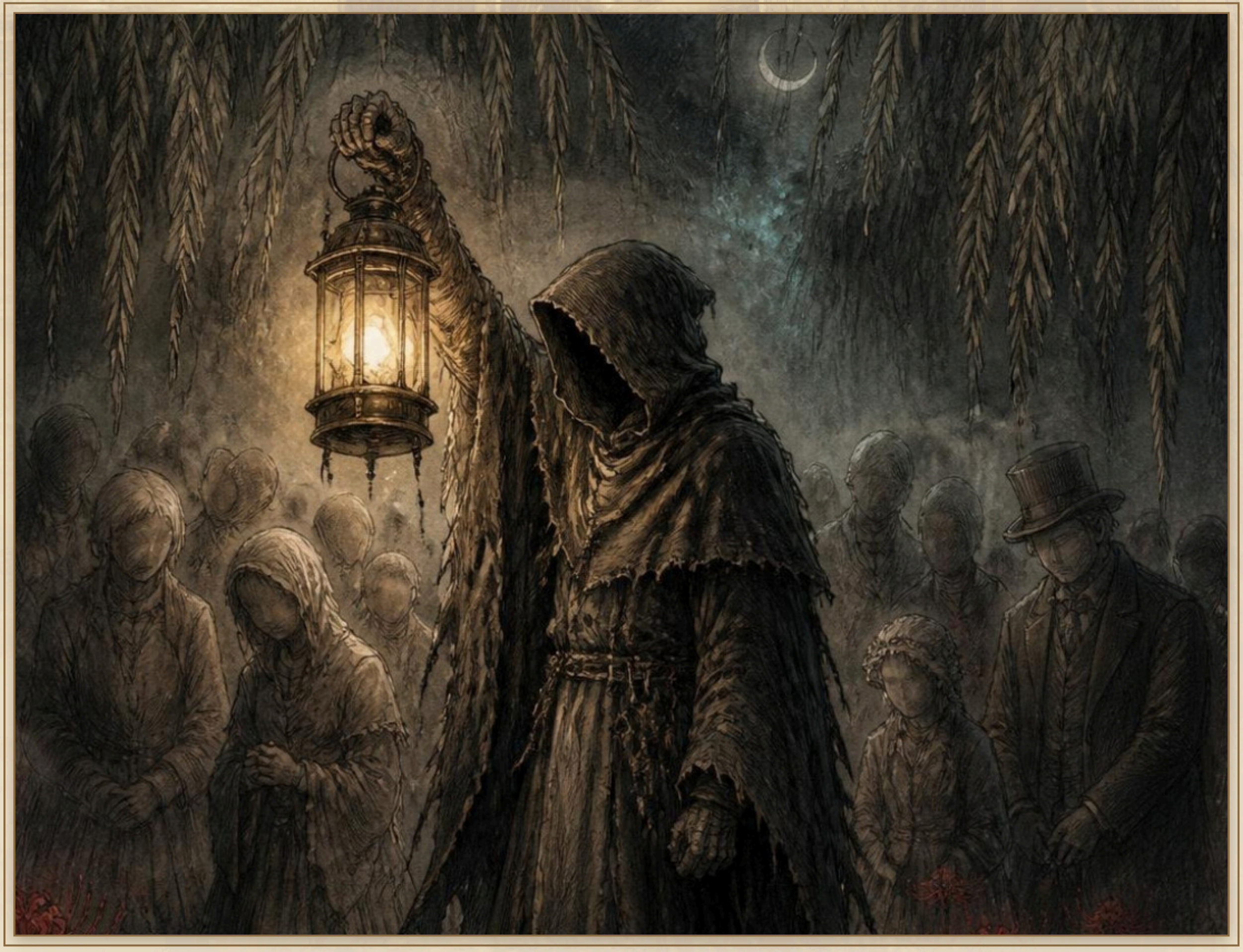
OPEN CROSSING

A nameless soul. You do not learn its story; you write it.

It came to the river without a name, without a coin, without a face anyone would remember. It has forgotten most of what it was. Even the old ferryman, who knows every soul by the weight of it in his boat, could not say who it had been. He did not refuse it; he simply did not see it, and it waited on the near shore until the Ferrymen did.

What remains are echoes. Sometimes, when the mist moves, there is a lantern left burning in a window, as if someone were still expected home. A bridge crossed every morning: the same planks, the same river underneath. An old woman selling chestnuts in the snow, her hands black from the coals. Water carried a long way for someone who never said thank you. An anger the soul once mistook for strength. And a ferryman, another one, who would not take its coin.

These echoes belong to no single life. They are what the river keeps of everyone it has ever carried, and this soul will wear whichever of them you give it. Every Open Crossing is a different person. Its Book begins empty; by the Far Shore it will be the only story the soul has.



WHAT THE FERRYMEN KNOW

Memory Sites call to it like half-familiar rooms, and each gives +2 Light. There is no Key Memory to find. There is only the Book, and what you write in it.

Twist: Memory Sites give +2 Light.

KEEPING THE BOOK

The Book has one page per Reach. Each page has four slots, **Place**, **Person**, **Deed** and **Feeling**, which fill a sentence about the soul's life.

You may **inscribe** a card when it Resonates, if its memory's slot is still empty on the current page. A **Key Memory** card may be inscribed whenever it is played face up. An inscribed card leaves the deck for good: you trade a useful card for a memory the soul will keep.

Chapter Blessing. When a page holds 3 memories (2 for the Garland Girl), the river grants the first of these that applies: mend a Fracture, drain Black Water, or return a forgotten card.

At the end, the Book is read aloud. Slots never filled read "...but this, the river has taken".

> Tuck an inscribed card into the well for its slot: slide its four corners into the photo corners. Slide it out again to reuse the card next game.

I · Who I Was

I was born near...

PLACE

...but this, the river has taken

I loved...

PERSON

...but this, the river has taken

I once...

DEED

...but this, the river has taken

and ever since I have carried...

FEELING

...but this, the river has taken

☐ Chapter Blessing

Keepsakes ☐ ☐ ☐

II · What I Did

At...

PLACE

...but this, the river has taken

before...

PERSON

...but this, the river has taken

I...

DEED

...but this, the river has taken

The price was...

FEELING

...but this, the river has taken

☐ Chapter Blessing

Keepsakes ☐ ☐ ☐

REACH III · THE BANKS OF LETHE

III · WHAT I CARRY

I go now, leaving...

PLACE

...but this, the river has taken

forgiving...

PERSON

...but this, the river has taken

unable to undo the day I...

DEED

...but this, the river has taken

holding only...

FEELING

...but this, the river has taken

☐ Chapter Blessing

Keepsakes ☐ ☐ ☐

THE FAR SHORE

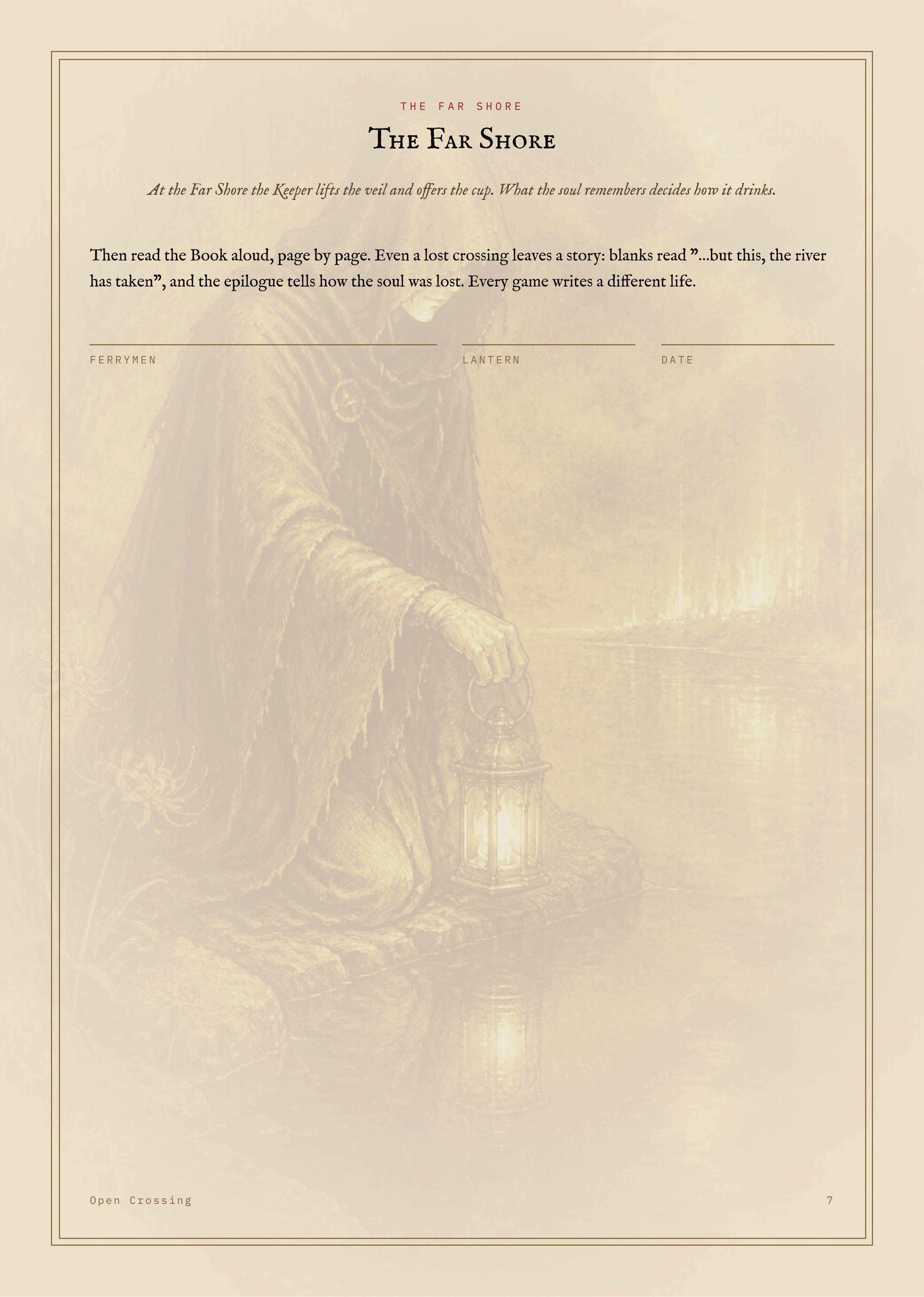
At the Far Shore the Keeper lifts the veil and offers the cup. What the soul remembers decides how it drinks.

Then read the Book aloud, page by page. Even a lost crossing leaves a story: blanks read ”…but this, the river has taken”, and the epilogue tells how the soul was lost. Every game writes a different life.

FERRYMEN

LANTERN

DATE



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